Digital Marketing Agency Launch

Execution Blueprint, Budgets, & Timelines for Aviel & Partner

Estimated Time to First Job

2 to 4 Weeks

Requires 30-50 high-quality, targeted proposals to break the "no history" barrier.

Month 1 Setup Cost

$80 - $95

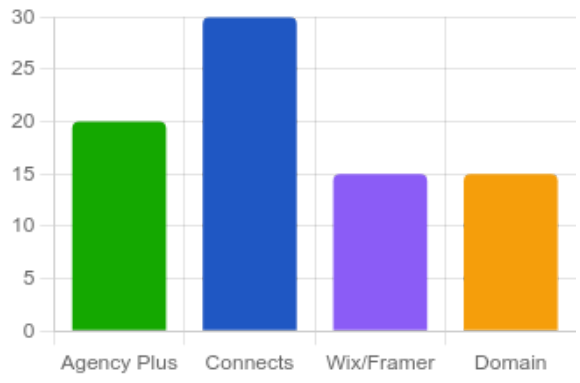
Covers Upwork Agency Plus, aggressive bidding connects, and website hosting.

Target Hourly Rate

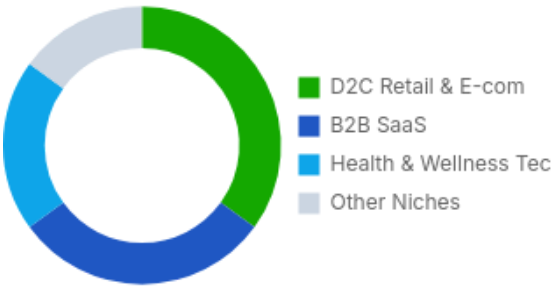
$25 - $45/hr

Starting rate. Switch to $2k-$5k flat-rate retainers after 3 successful 5-star reviews.

Initial Budget Breakdown (Month 1)



High-Growth Target Markets (2026)



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Itemized Tool & Startup Costs

Item	Purpose	Est. Cost
Upwork Agency Plus	Add partner, team profiles	$20 / mo
Upwork Connects	Buy ~200 connects for bidding	$30
Wix / Framer	Website Builder & CMS hosting	~$15 / mo
Custom Domain	Professional .com address	$15 / yr
Total Immediate Out-of-Pocket		**~$80**

AI Proposal & Writing Stack

Because you have no Upwork history, your proposal copy is your only leverage. Use these tools:

- **Uma (Upwork AI):** Built-in AI to draft initial cover letter structures based on job specs.
- **GigRadar:** Specialized tool for Upwork agencies to automate lead discovery and alert you to fresh jobs (speed is critical).
- **Manual Hook:** *Never* automate the first two sentences. Mention a specific detail from the client's website to prove you are a human reading their brief.

The Step-by-Step Launch Blueprint

Phase 1: Profile & "Loss Leader" Setup Days 1-3

Create the **Upwork Agency Account**. Invite your partner. Since the agency profile is blank, you must link your personal profiles so clients can see your 3 years of individual experience. For the first 3 jobs, bid on quick tasks (e.g., "Meta Pixel Setup" or "Ad Account Audit") at a 40% discount to secure immediate 5-star reviews specifically for the agency.

Phase 2: Website & Portfolio Integration Days 4-7

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Build a clean, minimalist site using **Framer** or **Wix Studio**. Don't just upload screenshots of past work. Use the **CSR Framework** for your 3 years of experience:

- **Challenge:** What was the client losing money on?
- **Strategy:** What exact funnel/tool did you implement?
- **Results:** Hard numbers (e.g., "Lowered CPA by 35% in 45 days").

Label this non-Upwork experience as "Representative Work from our Founders."

Phase 3: The "Audit Offer" Bidding Strategy Days 8-20

Begin high-volume bidding. Apply to 3-5 jobs a day. In your proposals, do not ask for the whole contract yet. Offer a "Loss Leader" action: *"I noticed your current landing page doesn't have [X]. I'd love to jump on a 15-minute call to give you a free Growth Audit of your 3 main competitors."*

Phase 4: Scaling to Retainers Days 21-30

Once you have 2-3 reviews on the agency profile, pivot away from hourly work. Target B2B SaaS or D2C E-commerce brands and pitch flat monthly retainers ($2,500+) plus a 10-15% performance fee on ad spend.

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